

UNI-ISABGOL

(Ispaghula Husk for Oral Consumption)

Description and Composition:

Pale to medium buff colored husks. Faint characteristic or bland mucilaginous taste. After reconstitution, it forms a gel like gelatinous mass.

Each bottle contains 100% w/w Ispaghula Husk.

Pharmacodynamics

Ispaghula husk is capable of absorbing up to 40 times its own weight of water in vitro and part of its activity can be attributed to its action as a simple bulking agent. In addition colonic bacteria are believed to use the hydrated material as a metabolic substrate. This results in an increase in the bacterial cell mass with a consequent softening of the faeces.

Pharmacokinetics

The mode of action of Uni-Isabgol is physical and does not depend on absorption into the systemic circulation.

Indications

To improve bowel movement in cases of constipation.

Recommended dose

Uni-Isabgol should be stirred into a glass of water and taken immediately, preferably after meals.

When preparing the product for administration, it is important to try to avoid inhaling any of the powder in order to minimize the risk of sensitization to the active ingredient.

Adults and children over 12 years: Two teaspoonfuls morning and evening.

Children 6 – 12 years: Half to one teaspoonful depending on size and age, morning and evening.

Children under 6 years: To be taken only when prescribed by a doctor. Half to one teaspoonful depending on size and age, morning and evening.

The last dose should not be taken immediately before going to sleep.

If there have been no bowel movements after 3 days of treatment a doctor should be consulted.

**Remarks: Two teaspoonfuls are approximately 3.5 grams.*

Other suggestions for use:

Mixes with any food and beverage without affecting taste:

- Mix Uni-Isabgol with any fresh fruit juice or favourite drinks. Stir well before drinking.
- Sprinkle Uni-Isabgol contents on favourite food.
- Mix Uni-Isabgol with any hot beverage, stir well before drinking.

Mode of administration

Oral route of administration.

Contraindication

Uni-Isabgol is contra-indicated in cases of intestinal obstruction, faecal impaction natural or drug-induced reduction of gut motility and colonic atony such as senile mega-colon. Hypersensitivity to the active substance or to any of the excipients in the product.

Warning and precautions

- Warning on hypersensitivity reactions: In individuals with continued occupational contact to powder of *Plantago ovata* seeds (i.e. healthcare workers, caregivers) allergic sensitization may occur due to inhalation, this is more frequent in atopic individuals. This sensitization usually leads to hypersensitivity reactions which could be serious.
- It is recommended to assess clinically the possible sensitization of individuals at risk and, if justified, to perform specific diagnostic tests. In case of proven sensitization leading to hypersensitivity reactions, exposure to the product should be stopped immediately and avoided in the future.
- Adequate fluid intake should be maintained. Therefore, they should always be taken with at least 150 mL of water or other liquid. The last dose should not be taken immediately before going to sleep since impaired or reduced gastric motility may impair the intestinal passage and then cause sub-obstruction.
- If the constipation does not resolve within 3 days or if abdominal pain occurs or in case of any irregularity of faeces, the use of psyllium should be discontinued and medical advice must be sought.
- Please consume a large amount of fluid/water when taking this product.

Interactions with other medicaments

Ispaghula and other bulk-forming laxatives may delay or reduce the gastrointestinal absorption of other drugs such as cardiac glycosides, coumarin derivatives, lithium, or vitamins (such as vitamin B₁₂) and minerals (such as calcium, iron, or zinc). Intervals of 30 minutes to 1 hour are recommended between ispaghula and other drugs or food, although some recommend as much as 3 hours between bulk-forming laxatives and other drugs. The dose of insulin may need to be reduced in diabetic patients taking ispaghula.

Pregnancy and lactation

Uni-Isabgol may be used during pregnancy and lactation since the ispaghula husk is not absorbed from the gastrointestinal tract.

Side effects

Ispaghula/psyllium husk contains potent allergens. The exposure to these allergens is possible through oral administration, contact with the skin and, in the case of powder formulations, also by inhalation. As a consequence to this allergic potential, individuals exposed to the product can develop hypersensitivity reactions such as rhinitis, conjunctivitis, bronchospasm and in some cases, anaphylaxis. Cutaneous symptoms as exanthema and/or pruritus have also been reported. Special attention should be given to individuals manipulating the powder formulations routinely.

A small amount of flatulence and abdominal distension may sometimes occur.

Symptoms and Treatment of over dose

In the event of over dosage conservative measures should be taken. The patient may notice abdominal discomfort and flatulence and attention should be paid to maintaining an adequate fluid intake, particularly if the granules have been taken without water, contrary to administration instructions.

Storage condition

Store below 30°C in a dry place, protect from moisture.

Shelf Life

36 months.

Presentation

100 g and 200 g of UNI-ISABGOL (Ispaghula Husk for Oral Consumption) each are packed in a HDPE bottle along with a package insert.

Manufacturer/**Product Registration Holder:**

KCK Pharmaceutical Industries Sdn. Bhd.
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